

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF ADVANCED SYSTEMS

Tender Reference: RFP/2026/CIV/895

Name of Work: Engagement of Managed Security Services Provider for SOC Operations

SECTION VI · DISPUTE RESOLUTION AND GENERAL CONDITIONS

Any dispute arising out of or in connection with this contract shall be referred to arbitration under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996, with New Delhi as the seat of arbitration.

All bid documents, correspondence and deliverables shall be submitted in English.

The contract shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India. The courts at the seat of arbitration shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

ANNEXURE · FORMATS AND DECLARATIONS

7.1 The bidder shall maintain complete confidentiality in respect of all data, drawings and specifications received from the Purchaser, and shall not disclose the same to any third party without prior written consent.

3.2 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

9.3 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 3 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

12.4 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

1.5 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

5.6 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not exceeding 6 hours, with a recovery time objective of 8 hours for the primary application tier.

12.7 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

9.8 The contractor shall comply with all applicable labour laws, minimum wage notifications and workmen's compensation requirements in respect of personnel deployed at site.

5.9 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 90 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

4.10 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

2.11 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

1.12 Helpdesk support shall be available on a round-the-clock basis, with first response within 15 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 8 hours.

11.13 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

9.14 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

1.15 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 1200 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

5.16 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

8.17 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

12.18 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 42U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 5 to 45 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 95 percent non-condensing.

7.19 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

1.20 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

9.21 The contractor shall conduct 4 structured training sessions for a minimum of 75 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

6.22 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

1.23 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

8.24 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 5 years from commissioning.

9.25 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

2.26 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

4.27 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 500 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 300 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

SECTION IV · PAYMENT TERMS

Payments shall be released against milestones as follows: 20% as mobilisation advance against an equivalent bank guarantee, 65% on delivery and installation, and the balance 15% on final acceptance testing and handover.

All payments shall be subject to deduction of tax at source as applicable. Invoices shall be raised only after written certification of the corresponding milestone by the project officer.

The contract shall be executed over a period of 12 months from the date of issue of the letter of award.

SPECIAL CONDITIONS OF CONTRACT

3.1 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

6.2 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

1.3 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 5000 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 300 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

11.4 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

11.5 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

2.6 Helpdesk support shall be available on a 12x6 basis, with first response within 45 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 4 hours.

5.7 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

4.8 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

6.9 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 42U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 0 to 50 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 80 percent non-condensing.

11.10 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

3.11 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

8.12 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 6 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

6.13 The bidder shall maintain complete confidentiality in respect of all data, drawings and specifications received from the Purchaser, and shall not disclose the same to any third party without prior written consent.

3.14 The contractor shall comply with all applicable labour laws, minimum wage notifications and workmen's compensation requirements in respect of personnel deployed at site.

12.15 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not exceeding 6 hours, with a recovery time objective of 2 hours for the primary application tier.

1.16 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

11.17 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

10.18 Redundancy shall be provided such that no single point of failure exists. Availability of not less than 99.9 percent shall be maintained on a monthly basis, excluding pre-approved

maintenance windows not exceeding 6 hours per month.

3.19 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

7.20 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

7.21 The contractor shall conduct 3 structured training sessions for a minimum of 20 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

7.22 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

6.23 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

2.24 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 5 years from commissioning.

5.25 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

9.26 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

2.27 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 1200 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

11.28 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

7.29 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

1.30 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 365 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

2.31 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

8.32 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

4.33 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 2500 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 500 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

5.34 The contractor shall comply with all applicable labour laws, minimum wage notifications and workmen's compensation requirements in respect of personnel deployed at site.

3.35 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

10.36 Helpdesk support shall be available on a 12x6 basis, with first response within 15 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 24 hours.

SECTION II · ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

The bidder shall satisfy each of the following pre-qualification requirements. Documentary evidence for every criterion shall be enclosed with the technical bid.

The bidder shall have a minimum of 5 years of experience in executing projects of a similar nature in the field of Cybersecurity.

The bidder shall hold valid ISO 9001:2015 and ISO 14001:2015 certifications as on the date of bid submission.

Joint ventures, consortiums and any form of collaborative bidding are strictly prohibited. Only single-entity bids shall be accepted.

Sub-contracting of the awarded work is permitted only up to 25% of the total contract value, and only with the prior written approval of the Purchaser.

For the limited purpose of empanelling sub-contractors, an indicative annual turnover of Rs. 5,00,00,000 is suggested. This is a guidance value only and is not a pre-qualification requirement for the bidder.

Purchase preference shall be extended to Class-I local suppliers in accordance with the prevailing Public Procurement (Preference to Make in India) Order.

INSTRUCTIONS TO BIDDERS

4.1 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

8.2 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

2.3 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 2500 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 500 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

5.4 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

12.5 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

9.6 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 3 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

12.7 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

10.8 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

5.9 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 365 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

11.10 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

6.11 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

4.12 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not

exceeding 24 hours, with a recovery time objective of 8 hours for the primary application tier.

4.13 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

9.14 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

10.15 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 1200 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

10.16 The Purchaser shall provide reasonable access to the site and to such existing records as are necessary for execution of the work, subject to the contractor's compliance with prevailing security and safety protocols.

2.17 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

3.18 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 5 years from commissioning.

5.19 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

2.20 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

8.21 The contractor shall conduct 3 structured training sessions for a minimum of 75 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

5.22 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

5.23 The contractor shall comply with all applicable labour laws, minimum wage notifications and workmen's compensation requirements in respect of personnel deployed at site.

1.24 Helpdesk support shall be available on a round-the-clock basis, with first response within 30 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 12 hours.

11.25 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

1.26 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

11.27 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 42U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 5 to 50 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 95 percent non-condensing.

5.28 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

4.29 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

5.30 Redundancy shall be provided such that no single point of failure exists. Availability of not less than 99.9 percent shall be maintained on a monthly basis, excluding pre-approved maintenance windows not exceeding 4 hours per month.

3.31 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

12.32 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

4.33 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 1000 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 800 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

3.34 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

SECTION III · FINANCIAL REQUIREMENTS

The bidder shall have achieved a minimum average annual turnover of Rs. 3,00,00,000 in each of the last three audited financial years.

Bids shall be accompanied by an Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs. 10,00,000, furnished as a demand draft or an unconditional bank guarantee.

A bank solvency certificate issued by a scheduled commercial bank within the preceding six months is mandatory and shall be enclosed with the technical bid.

Where a bidder is exempted from furnishing earnest money under a subsisting government notification, a bid security declaration shall be submitted in lieu thereof. The notional value of such declaration shall be reckoned as Rs. 12,50,000 solely for record-keeping purposes.

Bids shall remain valid for a period of 90 days from the date of opening of the technical bid.

SCOPE OF WORK

5.1 The bidder shall maintain complete confidentiality in respect of all data, drawings and specifications received from the Purchaser, and shall not disclose the same to any third party without prior written consent.

5.2 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

5.3 The contractor shall conduct 3 structured training sessions for a minimum of 20 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

6.4 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

12.5 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

7.6 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 250 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

2.7 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

11.8 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along

with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

10.9 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not exceeding 4 hours, with a recovery time objective of 2 hours for the primary application tier.

6.10 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

5.11 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

11.12 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 90 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

2.13 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

5.14 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

4.15 Helpdesk support shall be available on a 24x7 basis, with first response within 30 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 4 hours.

7.16 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

6.17 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

8.18 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 47U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 0 to 45 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 80 percent non-condensing.

8.19 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

12.20 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

3.21 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 3 years from commissioning.

3.22 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

8.23 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

11.24 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 2500 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 500 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

4.25 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

11.26 The Purchaser shall provide reasonable access to the site and to such existing records as are necessary for execution of the work, subject to the contractor's compliance with prevailing security and safety protocols.

5.27 Redundancy shall be provided such that no single point of failure exists. Availability of not less than 99.5 percent shall be maintained on a monthly basis, excluding pre-approved maintenance windows not exceeding 4 hours per month.

12.28 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

3.29 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

1.30 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 4 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

4.31 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

4.32 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

5.33 The contractor shall conduct 8 structured training sessions for a minimum of 30 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

9.34 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

1.35 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

6.36 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 250 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

7.37 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

National Institute of Advanced Systems, Pune, invites online bids from eligible and experienced bidders for the work titled 'Engagement of Managed Security Services Provider for SOC Operations' under reference number RFP/2026/CIV/895.

The last date and time for submission of bids is 6 October 2027 at 15:00 hours IST.

A pre-bid meeting shall be convened on 11 August 2027 at the office of the National Institute of Advanced Systems.

A non-refundable tender document fee of Rs. 2,000 shall be paid online at the time of bid submission.

Bidders shall register on the e-procurement portal and obtain a valid digital signature certificate of Class III or above prior to submission.

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

1.1 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

5.2 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

10.3 Helpdesk support shall be available on a 24x7 basis, with first response within 15 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 8 hours.

10.4 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

10.5 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

4.6 The contractor shall conduct 4 structured training sessions for a minimum of 75 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

11.7 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

2.8 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

5.9 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 2400 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

12.10 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

4.11 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

1.12 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 90 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

10.13 The Purchaser shall provide reasonable access to the site and to such existing records as are necessary for execution of the work, subject to the contractor's compliance with prevailing security and safety protocols.

7.14 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

2.15 Redundancy shall be provided such that no single point of failure exists. Availability of not less than 99.5 percent shall be maintained on a monthly basis, excluding pre-approved maintenance windows not exceeding 4 hours per month.

5.16 The contractor shall comply with all applicable labour laws, minimum wage notifications and workmen's compensation requirements in respect of personnel deployed at site.

11.17 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

6.18 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 6 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

5.19 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

8.20 The bidder shall maintain complete confidentiality in respect of all data, drawings and specifications received from the Purchaser, and shall not disclose the same to any third

party without prior written consent.

7.21 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 3 years from commissioning.

2.22 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

1.23 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

6.24 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 42U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 0 to 40 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 90 percent non-condensing.

5.25 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

10.26 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

3.27 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 5000 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 200 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

7.28 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

1.29 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

8.30 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not exceeding 6 hours, with a recovery time objective of 2 hours for the primary application tier.

11.31 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

6.32 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

2.33 Helpdesk support shall be available on a 12x6 basis, with first response within 30 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 4 hours.

8.34 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

6.35 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

SECTION V · PENALTIES, GUARANTEES AND LIABILITY

In the event of delay in completion, liquidated damages shall be levied at 0.25% of the contract value per fortnight of delay, subject to an overall ceiling of 10% of the total contract value.

The successful bidder shall furnish a performance bank guarantee equal to 10% of the

contract value, valid for 24 months from the date of award.

All supplied equipment shall carry a comprehensive on-site warranty of 2 years from the date of successful commissioning.

The aggregate liability of the contractor under this contract shall not exceed 150% of the total contract value, save in cases of fraud, wilful misconduct or breach of confidentiality obligations.

Separately, failure to depute the approved project manager within thirty days of award shall attract a one-time administrative penalty of 2% of the first milestone value, which shall be recovered from the next due payment and shall not count towards the liquidated damages ceiling.

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

6.1 Any notice required to be given under this contract shall be in writing and shall be deemed to have been served when delivered by hand against acknowledgement or by registered post.

11.2 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

3.3 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 6 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

9.4 The contractor shall not assign or transfer the contract or any part thereof, or any benefit or interest therein, without the prior written consent of the Purchaser.

7.5 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

4.6 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 1200 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.

9.7 Any clarification sought by prospective bidders shall be addressed to the office of the undersigned in writing. Responses to material clarifications shall be published as a corrigendum on the portal and shall form an integral part of this document.

11.8 The Purchaser shall provide reasonable access to the site and to such existing records as are necessary for execution of the work, subject to the contractor's compliance with prevailing security and safety protocols.

8.9 Backup of all configuration and transactional data shall be taken at intervals not exceeding 24 hours, with a recovery time objective of 8 hours for the primary application tier.

3.10 The bidder shall be deemed to have satisfied itself as to the correctness and sufficiency of the bid and of the rates and prices quoted, which shall cover all its obligations under the contract.

11.11 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

1.12 All software supplied shall be licensed in the name of the Purchaser in perpetuity, with entitlement to updates and patches for a period of not less than 7 years from commissioning.

1.13 Bidders are advised to read all instructions contained in this document carefully before preparing and submitting their bids. Non-compliance with any instruction may render a bid liable to rejection at the sole discretion of the Purchaser.

11.14 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of

the Purchaser.

4.15 Helpdesk support shall be available on a round-the-clock basis, with first response within 15 minutes for critical incidents and resolution within 4 hours.

8.16 No escalation in rates shall be admissible on account of variation in statutory levies, exchange rates or market prices during the currency of the contract, unless expressly provided herein.

2.17 All pages of the bid document shall be serially numbered and signed by the authorised signatory of the bidder. Any interlineation, erasure or overwriting shall be valid only if initialled by the person signing the bid.

2.18 All active components shall be rack-mountable in standard 42U enclosures and shall support front-to-rear airflow. Operating temperature range shall be 0 to 45 degrees Celsius at relative humidity of up to 95 percent non-condensing.

1.19 Bids shall be submitted online through the designated e-procurement portal. Physical bids sent by post, courier, facsimile or electronic mail shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

5.20 The bidder shall maintain complete confidentiality in respect of all data, drawings and specifications received from the Purchaser, and shall not disclose the same to any third party without prior written consent.

4.21 The proposed solution shall sustain a minimum of 500 concurrent transactions per second at a ninety-fifth percentile response time not exceeding 300 milliseconds, as demonstrated during acceptance testing.

9.22 The contractor shall submit monthly progress reports in the prescribed format, along with an updated project schedule reflecting actual progress against planned milestones.

9.23 The Purchaser reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, and to annul the bidding process and reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders.

10.24 The contractor shall conduct 8 structured training sessions for a minimum of 75 designated personnel, and shall furnish training material in editable soft-copy format.

2.25 Force majeure events shall include acts of God, war, civil commotion, epidemic and any order of a competent authority that renders performance impossible. Notice shall be given within fifteen days of the occurrence of such event.

2.26 Nothing in this document shall be construed as creating any obligation on the part of the Purchaser to shortlist, negotiate with, or award a contract to any bidder responding hereto.

2.27 Redundancy shall be provided such that no single point of failure exists. Availability of not less than 99.5 percent shall be maintained on a monthly basis, excluding pre-approved maintenance windows not exceeding 6 hours per month.

10.28 The Purchaser shall provide reasonable access to the site and to such existing records as are necessary for execution of the work, subject to the contractor's compliance with prevailing security and safety protocols.

4.29 Conditional bids, bids with deviations from the mandatory technical specifications, and bids received after the prescribed deadline shall be summarily rejected without further correspondence.

6.30 Physical security of the installation shall include access control with audit logging retained for a minimum of 90 days, and surveillance coverage of all equipment rooms.

1.31 Insurance cover for the full replacement value of all materials in transit and at site shall be arranged by the contractor at its own cost, with the Purchaser named as co-insured.

2.32 The Purchaser may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for submission of bids by

issuing a corrigendum, in which case all rights and obligations of the Purchaser and the bidders shall stand extended to the revised deadline.

10.33 The contractor shall carry out preventive maintenance at least once every 4 months during the support period, and shall submit a signed checklist after each visit.

10.34 The successful bidder shall depute a full-time project manager for the entire duration of the contract. Any replacement of key personnel shall require prior written approval of the Purchaser.

5.35 Upon completion, the contractor shall remove all temporary works, surplus materials and debris from the site and restore the premises to the satisfaction of the engineer-in-charge.

8.36 All cabling shall conform to the applicable structured cabling standard and shall be tested end-to-end. Test reports for a minimum of 500 ports shall be submitted in soft copy prior to commissioning.